

Technology News



OMAP MDP supports LiMo, Android

Texas Instruments has unveiled an enhanced version of its OMAP 3 processor-based development platform—the ZoomTM OMAP34x-II Mobile Development Platform (MDP), which has been designed, developed, and manufactured by Logica. The new platform is targeted at smartphone and mobile internet device (MID) application developers who want to create applications for the Android Mobile Platform, Linux, LiMo, Symbian and Windows Mobile. It offers them a robust handheld form factor with the wireless connectivity technologies, enhanced imaging, video, display technology, software, as well as an optional 3G modem and optional DLP PicoTM projection technology module that enables big picture experiences in the palm of your hand.

Out-of-the-box features of the Zoom OMAP34x-II MDP include the following: 4.1-inch WVGA multi-touch display with a QWERTY keypad in a landscape, handheld form factor; high performance OMAP3430 applications processor that supports up to 720p HD video encode/decode; wireless connectivity technology from TI, including WiLinkTM 6.0 (WL1271); a single chip with Wi-Fi, Bluetooth and FM functionality; NaviLink GPS functionality; 8 MP camera sensor; optional 3G modem solution, as well as flexibility to support any third party modem through an extension card. Go to www.ti.com/orderzoom for information on how to order.



The new XenServer release is free for all

Citrix Systems has unveiled the new version of XenServer that will be offered free of charge to any user for unlimited production deployment. With this new release, XenServer adds powerful new features like centralised multi-node management, multi-server resource sharing and full live motion. Powerful centralised management enables full multi-node management for an unlimited number of servers and virtual machines; includes easy physical-to-virtual and virtual-to-virtual conversion tools, centralised configuration management and a resilient distributed management architecture. As for Live Motion and Multi-Server Resource Sharing, they incorporate the XenMotion technology that allows virtual machines to be moved from server to server, without service interruption ensuring zero downtime. Also included are optimal initial virtual machine placement and intelligent maintenance mode.

"Free hypervisors with limited functionality have been around for a long time. We see this move as substantially different because it offers a competitive, enterprise-ready virtual infrastructure platform with fully centralised management, live motion and support for unlimited virtual machines and servers—with no strings attached," said Mark Bowker, analyst, Enterprise Strategy Group.

The free XenServer release will be available for download from the Citrix website and other download portals by the end of March 2009. You can preview the XenServer release at www.citrix.com/freexenserver

ACCESS Linux Platform 3 goes 3D

ACCESS, a provider of advanced software technologies to the mobile and 'beyond-the-PC' markets, showcased ACCESS Linux Platform v3.0 at this year's GSMA Mobile World Congress in Barcelona, Spain. The next generation of the company's flagship mobile Linux platform features advanced UI capabilities and LiMo compliance, and will be made available soon according to the company.

According to the release, "ACCESS Linux Platform v3.0 features an advanced

UI engine and middleware that enable licensees to create state-of-the-art user experiences with Hollywood-style graphics and transition effects with added support for 2.5 and 3D graphics environments. Enhanced flexibility allows different applications, from different environments, to co-exist and be concurrently executed. Content, such as contacts, appointments, videos or photos, can be rendered anywhere, not just within one application."



The ACCESS Linux Platform v3.0 SDK enables the development of native applications for LiMo-compliant devices. By wielding the full power of the Eclipse IDE software development platform, the ACCESS Linux Platform v3.0 SDK runs in the ACCESS Linux Platform Simulator. Also available on the ACCESS Developer Network (ADN) website at www.accessdevnet.com, the SDK allows users to create user interfaces with GUI builder tools.